

Resilience & Growth Mindset

Character **First****GOALS MONTH 6**

- You distinguish a fixed mindset reaction from a growth mindset reaction in yourself
- You rewrite at least one negative self-thought into a learning-oriented formulation
- You name three concrete ways you have grown this season compared to yourself

How you deal with setbacks and mistakes determines how far you go in sports and in life. A growth mindset is not innate. You can train it.

EXERCISE 1 — REWRITE THE MISTAKE**1 Rewrite the Mistake**

Write down a recent mistake or setback. Then rewrite every thought with "I can't" to "I can't yet" and add what you learn from it.

The situation or mistake:

WHAT I THOUGHT (fixed)**HOW I REWRITE IT (growth)****EXERCISE 2 — PROGRESS LIST****2 3 Things I Can Do Better Than Last Month**

No comparison with others. Only with yourself. Write three concrete things.

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

EXERCISE 3 — MY HARDEST MOMENT**3 Hardest Moment of This Season**

Describe the hardest moment of this season. What did you do? What did you learn? How did you become stronger?

What was the moment?

What did I learn from it?

"I have failed over and over again in my life. And that is why I succeed."

Michael Jordan — 6x NBA Champion

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SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATION — EVIDENCE PYRAMID

Meta-analysis Burnette et al. (2013) — 113 studies: growth mindset correlates with learning goals and better performance in adolescents. *Psychological Bulletin*.

Systematic Review Meijen et al. (2020) — cognitive reframing is most evidence-based strategy for resilience in sport. *Frontiers in Psychology*.

Longitudinal Martin & Marsh (2009) — resilience is a better predictor of long-term success than IQ or motivation.

GUIDANCE REWRITE THE MISTAKE

- 1 Introduce fixed vs. growth mindset with real personal example: "I always thought I wasn't fast enough..."
- 2 Individual writing. May stay private. Then: who shares the "rewritten" version? Focus on learning, not the mistake.

COACH TIPS FOR THIS THEME

Tip 1: Change your own language. Stop "That's not for you." Start "You haven't mastered that yet."

Tip 2: Progress List as fixed ritual every session. Players who see improvement need less external validation.

Tip 3: Month 6 = fatigue and motivation dip. This theme is deliberately placed here as reorientation.

⚠ Growth mindset can backfire as camouflage for lack of support. Always combine with concrete tools and individual guidance.

TIMING

- ☐ Introduction fixed vs. growth mindset: 8 minutes
- ☐ Individual worksheet: 10 minutes
- ☐ Group reflection on rewritten mistakes: 10 minutes
- ☐ Progress list and closing: 7 minutes